Application Form & Identity Verification Guide

UCRM Internal Training Document

Version: English

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Audience: Account Managers & Client Follow-up

1. Overview: What to Do After Receiving Client Documents

When a client uploads the following documents to the system's file center, it means they are ready to start the customs bond application. When you see these files appear, follow this two-step process:

Step 1: Document Verification. Carefully review every file the client uploaded. Confirm that names, addresses, expiration dates, and photos match and are valid and clear. This is the most critical step. If the documents have problems, everything after that is wasted effort.

Step 2: Send the Cold Outreach Email. Once verification is complete with no issues, send the first email to the client using the templates in the outreach training guide, and begin the application follow-up process.

> **Why this verification matters:**
> The surety company will use the documents we submit to run background checks. If a name is misspelled, an address doesn't match, or a credential is expired, the surety will reject the application outright and the client will blame us for being unprofessional. Catching these issues upfront saves us from rework.

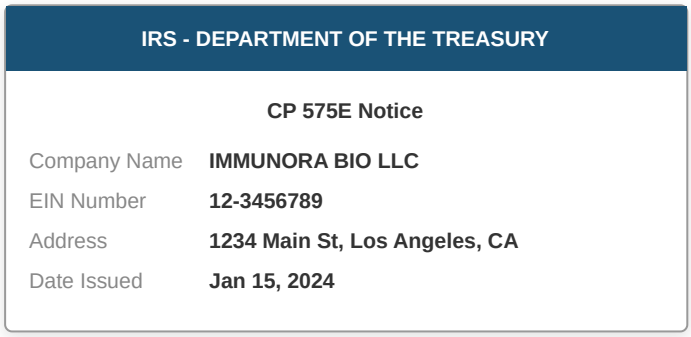
2. What Documents Clients Provide

Every client company uploads the following files. Below is a detailed explanation of each document, what to look for, and how to verify it.

E EIN Letter (EIN.pdf)

What it is: The federal Employer Identification Number, the company's tax ID, formatted as two digits, a hyphen, and seven digits, e.g., 12-3456789.

What's inside: An IRS CP 575E notice letter showing the company's legal name, EIN number, and registered address.



IRS - DEPARTMENT OF THE TREASURY

CP 575E Notice

Company Name	**IMMUNORA BIO LLC**
EIN Number	**12-3456789**
Address	**1234 Main St, Los Angeles, CA**
Date Issued	**Jan 15, 2024**

What to check:

First, the company legal name. This must match exactly the owner's name on the passport and the company name on the articles of organization — every letter must match.

Second, the EIN number. This number will be used repeatedly on application forms, so copy it correctly.

Third, the registered address. This should match the address proof the client provides later.

> **Verification checklist:**
> ☐ Does the company name end in LLC? All our clients are LLCs.
> ☐ Is the EIN format correct? It should be XX-XXXXXXX.
> ☐ Does the name match the articles of organization exactly?

S Social Security Number (SSN.txt)

What it is: The owner's personal U.S. Social Security number, formatted as XXX-XX-XXXX.

What to check: This is sensitive personal information. Clients usually type it into a text file or send it via private message. Do not forward it casually; only enter it when required on application forms.

> **Important:** The SSN is highly sensitive. Do not repeat the full SSN in emails, and do not send screenshots containing the SSN to anyone. Enter it directly on forms when needed; do not save it in intermediate files.

A Articles of Organization

What it is: The document filed with the state government when the company was registered, proving the LLC legally exists. It shows the company name, filing date, and registered agent.



CALIFORNIA SECRETARY OF STATE

Articles of Organization

Entity Name	**IMMUNORA BIO LLC**
Entity Type	**Limited Liability Company**
Date Filed	**Jan 10, 2024**
Registered Agent	**CA Registered Agents Inc.**

What to check:

First, does the company name match the EIN letter?

Second, the filing date. The older the company, the better. Surety companies are more cautious with companies less than a year old.

Third, the state of registration. Different states have different LLC fees, but this does not affect the bond application.

A Address Verification (address.png)

What it is: Proof of the company's business address, usually a map screenshot from Google Maps.



What to check:

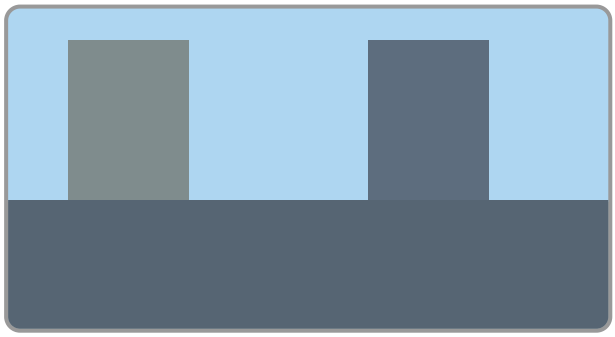
First, is this a real commercial address? It cannot be a residential address or a virtual mailbox.

Second, does the address match the registered address on the EIN letter?

> **Verification checklist:**
>
> ☐ Does the address look like a warehouse or office building?
>
> ☐ Is it a residential area? If so, remind the client to use a commercial address.
>
> ☐ Is the street number clear?

S Street View (streetview.png)

What it is: A Google Street View screenshot showing what the building looks like from the road.



What to check: Confirm that the address is actually a commercial building, not a private home. The surety company sometimes checks Google Maps themselves; if they find a residential address, they will reject the application.

P Passport (passport.jpg)

What it is: The owner's passport photo page, with photo and personal information.



What to check:

First, the name. The name on the passport must match exactly the owner name on the EIN letter and the name entered on the application.

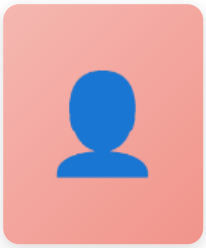
Second, the expiration date. The passport must be valid; expired passports are not accepted.

Third, the photo. It must be clear and match the owner's selfie photo they provide later.

> **Verification checklist:**
> ☐ Is the passport valid for at least another 6 months?
> ☐ Does the name match the owner name on the EIN letter?
> ☐ Is the photo clear enough to recognize the person?
> ☐ Copy the passport number; it will be needed on later forms.

O Owner Photo (owner-photo.jpg)

What it is: A recent selfie or casual photo of the owner, used to compare against the passport photo to confirm it is the same person.

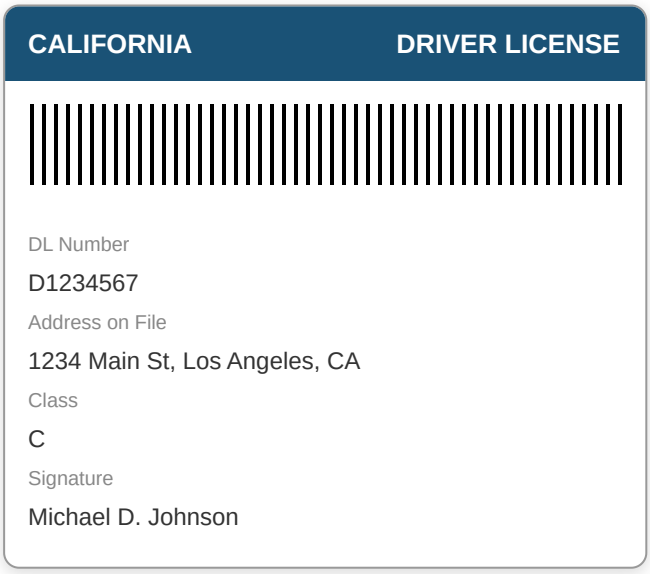


What to check: Compare this photo side by side with the passport photo. Look at facial features: eye shape, nose bridge, chin. If they look like two different people, send it back and ask for a new photo.

> **Why we ask for this:** Surety companies worry about applications filed by someone else using another person's documents. Providing a recent photo upfront speeds up review.

ID Driver License Back (id-back.jpg)

What it is: The back of the U.S. driver license, with signature and magnetic stripe.



What to check: Confirm the address. The address on the driver license helps verify the owner's residential address. The driver license number is sometimes requested on application forms.

N Application Notice (notice.pdf)

What it is: An auto-generated system notice indicating this client has entered the application workflow. Receiving this file means all prerequisite documents are in order and it is time to fill out the application.

✓ Application Documents Complete

Client: Immunora Bio LLC

Owner: Michael D. Johnson

Status: Ready to begin bond application forms

What to do: When you see this notice, document verification is complete. The next step is to send the cold outreach email and begin follow-up.

3. How to Verify It Is Really the Owner

This is where mistakes most often happen. Surety companies are most worried about applications filed by someone else using a borrowed passport and SSN. We need to catch these issues upfront.

3.1 Three Matching Principles

First, name consistency. List the owner's name as it appears on every document: passport, driver license, EIN letter, articles of organization. These must all match exactly, including middle names. If the passport says Michael David Johnson but the EIN letter only says Michael Johnson, ask the client why the middle name is missing.

Second, photo consistency. Compare the passport photo and the owner's selfie side by side. Look at facial features: eye shape, nose bridge, chin. If they look like two different people, send it back immediately.

Third, address consistency. The owner's residential address must match the address on the driver license. The company business address must match the registered address on the EIN letter. These two addresses can be different — one is home, one is the office — but each must be internally consistent.

3.2 Common Issues

Issue	How to Handle
Passport photo is old; person has gained weight	Ask the client to renew the passport, or provide a recent selfie holding that day's newspaper
Company name on EIN letter differs from articles	Confirm with the client whether they changed the name; a name change requires filing an amendment with the state
Address is residential, not commercial	Remind the client to rent a commercial address or virtual office; residential addresses get rejected
Passport is expired	Ask the client to renew the passport first; expired credentials cannot be used

4. Step 2: Send the Cold Outreach Email

Once document verification is complete and clean, send the first email. For email content, refer to the separate training guide "Broker FAQ & Outreach Training," which contains over a dozen templates in different styles that you can adapt.

After sending the email, change the client's status in the system from "New Lead" to "Pending Customs Broker Review," and add a note: which email was sent on which day, and when the client replied.

> **Tip:** Do not rush to send the email before finishing document review. If you later find an expired passport or mismatched address, the client will think we are unprofessional.

5. Common Application Fields

The surety company sends several forms to fill out. Below are the most common ones, field by field.

5.1 Bond Application

This is the main form, collecting company and owner basic information.

CUSTOMS BOND APPLICATION

Applicant Name	**Company legal name, exactly as on EIN letter**
EIN Number	**XX-XXXXXXX, copied from EIN letter**
Business Address	**Company address, matching address verification**
Phone Number	**Company phone number**
Email	**Client contact email**
Owner Name	**Owner name, matching passport**
Owner SSN	**Owner Social Security number**
Owner DOB	**Owner date of birth**
Bond Amount	**Usually 10% of import volume, minimum $50k**
Effective Date	**Expected first import date**

5.2 Power of Attorney (POA)

This form authorizes us as the client's customs broker, representing the client with CBP and the surety company.

Note: This form must be printed, signed in person by the owner, then scanned and uploaded. Some surety companies do not accept electronic signatures; printing, signing, and scanning is safest.

5.3 Personal Financial Statement

This form is covered in detail in the separate guide "Financial Statement Guide." Not repeated here.

Forms requiring printed signature: POA, financial statement signature page, bond agreement. These three must be signed by hand by the owner; typed names are not accepted.

6. Three Real-World Scenarios

Scenario 1: Complete Documents, One Pass

The client is an import company owner in Los Angeles named James. He uploaded EIN, passport, articles of organization, address screenshots, and driver license. We opened the files: company name matches EIN, passport valid through 2030, address is a commercial warehouse, photos match. We sent the cold outreach email and got approval three weeks later.

Scenario 2: Residential Address Sent Back

The client is Sarah in Dallas. The street view screenshot clearly shows a single-family home with a front yard and mailbox. We emailed her explaining that the surety requires a commercial address, and asked her to rent a virtual office or warehouse address before resubmitting. She changed the address two weeks later and resubmitted.

Scenario 3: Expired Passport

The client is William in Chicago. His passport expiration date showed it expired last year. We reminded him that he must renew the passport first before applying. He went to the post office for expedited service, received the new passport three weeks later, and we resumed the process.

7. How Surety Companies Review

Understanding the surety's review logic tells us what to pay special attention to.

7.1 What They Look At

First, whether the company really exists. They check the state government website to confirm the LLC is active and not revoked.

Second, whether the owner really exists. They use the SSN to run a credit check, looking for bankruptcies, tax liens, and credit scores.

Third, whether the address is real. They check Google Maps themselves to see if the address is a commercial building.

Fourth, financial strength. This is the personal financial statement we help the client fill out — they look at net worth.

7.2 Common Rejection Reasons

Rejection Reason	How to Prevent Upfront
Residential address	Check street view as the first step when receiving documents
Owner credit score too low	Warn the client upfront; low credit makes approval difficult
Company less than 3 months old	Very new companies require extra documentation from the surety
Inconsistent names across documents	Verify ourselves first; do not wait for the surety to find it

8. Closing Note

The above is our internal operating guide. For edge cases — such as a client who is a foreign national without an SSN, a newly formed company, or difficulty finding a commercial address — do not make judgment calls on your own. Confirm with a supervisor before replying to the client.

Our goal is to get the documents right the first time, so the client does not have to send supplements back and forth. Better client experience means better efficiency for us.